Literary Research Analysis Title	Methods and Materials	Reason/Justification and the Research Gap
1. When the River Gives and Takes: An Ecocritical Analysis of Nature, Reciprocity, and Human Greed in the Legend of Maria Tang-an of Bojo River	**Design:** Descriptive qualitative research design using **literary analysis**, particularly **ecocriticism**. The study will examine how the legend represents the relationship between humans and nature through Maria Tang-an, Bojo River, and the actions of the villagers. It will focus on themes such as environmental respect, generosity, reciprocity, greed, responsibility, and the consequences of abusing nature and its resources. **Respondents:** No human respondents are needed because the study focuses on the **literary analysis of documented versions of the folklore** rather than collecting information through surveys or interviews. The legend itself and its recorded retellings will serve as the main materials for analysis. **Source:** Since Maria Tang-an is part of an oral folklore tradition and does not have a single identified author, the study will use documented accounts of the legend. Suggested sources in APA style include:	The legend of **Maria Tang-an** is suitable for this study because it presents a strong relationship between **human behavior and the natural environment**. Local accounts describe Maria Tang-an as the guardian of Bojo River who helped residents by lending plates, utensils, clothing, and other items needed for celebrations. This relationship ended when people failed to properly return the borrowed objects or returned them damaged. From an ecocritical perspective, Maria Tang-an's generosity can represent **nature's ability to provide for human needs**, while the villagers' misuse of what she provides may symbolize **human exploitation, irresponsibility, and failure to respect natural resources**. Her withdrawal of assistance can therefore be interpreted as a warning about what may happen when the relationship between people and nature becomes abusive rather than reciprocal. **Research Gap:** In the sources reviewed for this proposed study, the Maria Tang-an legend is mainly presented as part of **Bojo River's**

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	Zeta-Yap, E. A. (2015). *Aloguinsan, Cebu: An eco-cultural cruise down the Bojo River*. EAZY Traveler. EAZY Traveler article SunStar Cebu. (2016, October 13). *Super Suroy: Aloguinsan*. *SunStar*. SunStar article The Broken Halo. (2014, May 1). *The tale of Maria Tang-an in Bojo River, Aloguinsan*. *The Broken Halo*. The Broken Halo article **Data Analysis:** The study will use **close reading, thematic analysis, and ecocritical interpretation**. Important scenes, characters, symbols, settings, and actions will be identified and grouped into themes such as **generosity, human greed, respect for nature, reciprocity, broken trust, and consequences**. Maria Tang-an will be examined as a symbolic guardian of nature, while Bojo River will be analyzed as more than a setting—as a natural and sacred space connected to the community. The act of	**local folklore, tourism, cultural heritage, and oral tradition**. For example, existing accounts primarily retell how Maria Tang-an guarded the river and lent objects to the community. However, these sources give limited attention to a focused **literary and ecocritical interpretation** of the legend. This study will address that gap by examining how the legend uses Maria Tang-an, Bojo River, the borrowed objects, and the villagers' actions to represent the relationship between **nature and humanity**, particularly the ideas of generosity, reciprocity, environmental respect, greed, and the consequences of abusing what nature provides.

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	borrowing and returning objects will also be interpreted as a symbol of the relationship between humans and the resources provided by nature.	